

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 33

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1. Affluent

Meaning: Wealthy or having plenty of money and resources.

Tip to remember: Affluent sounds like “a fluent flow.” Money flows easily to an affluent person.

Sentence: The affluent neighborhood had large houses and clean streets.

2. Allegorical

Meaning: Having a hidden symbolic meaning, often moral or political.

Tip to remember: An allegory is a story where characters and events represent deeper ideas. Allegorical means symbolic.

Sentence: The novel is allegorical because the animals represent political leaders.

3. Allude

Meaning: To refer to something indirectly.

Tip to remember: Allude sounds like “a clue.” When you allude to something, you give a clue instead of saying it directly.

Sentence: The speaker alluded to recent political events without naming them.

4. Amplify

Meaning: To increase, enlarge, or make stronger.

Tip to remember: An amplifier makes sound louder. Amplify means to make something stronger or larger.

Sentence: Social media can amplify both useful information and false rumors.

5. Catastrophic

Meaning: Extremely disastrous or causing great damage.

Tip to remember: Think of a catastrophe like a huge earthquake or flood. Catastrophic means disaster-level.

Sentence: The catastrophic flood destroyed many homes.

6. Contemporary

Meaning: Existing at the same time; modern or current.

Tip to remember: “Con” means together, and “temporary” relates to time. Contemporary things belong to the same time.

Sentence: Contemporary research focuses heavily on renewable energy.

7. **Conundrum**
Meaning: A difficult problem or confusing question.
Tip to remember: Conundrum sounds like a confusing drumbeat in your head. It represents a puzzle.
Sentence: Balancing low cost and high reliability is a major engineering conundrum.
8. **Defame**
Meaning: To damage someone's reputation by saying false or harmful things.
Tip to remember: Defame means to reduce someone's fame.
Sentence: The article tried to defame the honest official.
9. **Detract**
Meaning: To reduce the value, importance, or quality of something.
Tip to remember: Detract sounds like "subtract." It subtracts value from something.
Sentence: A few grammar errors detracted from the quality of the essay.
10. **Detrimental**
Meaning: Harmful or damaging.
Tip to remember: Detrimental sounds like "damage mental." Something detrimental damages progress, health, or success.
Sentence: Lack of sleep is detrimental to exam performance.
11. **Devious**
Meaning: Dishonest, indirect, or tricky.
Tip to remember: Devious sounds like "deviate." A devious person deviates from the honest path.
Sentence: The devious salesman tricked customers into paying more.
12. **Dormant**
Meaning: Inactive or sleeping, but able to become active later.
Tip to remember: Dormant sounds like dormitory. People sleep in a dormitory; dormant things are sleeping or inactive.
Sentence: The volcano had been dormant for many years.
13. **Draconian**
Meaning: Extremely harsh, strict, or severe.
Tip to remember: Think of a dragon-like ruler making cruel rules. Draconian rules are very harsh.
Sentence: The school introduced draconian penalties for cheating.
14. **Egalitarian**
Meaning: Believing in equality for all people.
Tip to remember: Egalitarian sounds like equal. It means supporting equal rights and opportunities.
Sentence: The policy was praised for its egalitarian approach.
15. **Elusive**
Meaning: Difficult to find, catch, or understand.

Tip to remember: Elusive sounds like “escape.” Something elusive escapes your grasp.

Sentence: A simple solution to the problem remained elusive.

16. **Erstwhile**

Meaning: Former; previous.

Tip to remember: Erstwhile sounds old-fashioned, and it means something from an earlier time.

Sentence: The erstwhile leader returned to politics after many years.

17. **Gloat**

Meaning: To show excessive satisfaction, especially over someone else’s failure.

Tip to remember: Think of someone smiling proudly after another person loses. That person is gloating.

Sentence: He did not gloat after winning the competition.

18. **Harrowing**

Meaning: Extremely distressing or frightening.

Tip to remember: Harrowing sounds like “horror.” A harrowing experience feels horrible and painful.

Sentence: The survivors told harrowing stories about the earthquake.

19. **Indefinite**

Meaning: Not clear, fixed, or certain.

Tip to remember: Definite means clear and fixed. Indefinite means not definite.

Sentence: The meeting was postponed for an indefinite period.

20. **Ingenious**

Meaning: Clever, inventive, and creative.

Tip to remember: Ingenious sounds like genius. An ingenious solution shows genius-like creativity.

Sentence: The student proposed an ingenious method to reduce energy loss.

21. **Keen**

Meaning: Sharp, eager, or very interested.

Tip to remember: A keen knife is sharp; a keen mind is also sharp.

Sentence: She has a keen interest in power systems.

22. **Multifaceted**

Meaning: Having many different aspects or features.

Tip to remember: A diamond has many facets, or faces. A multifaceted problem has many sides.

Sentence: Climate change is a multifaceted issue involving science, policy, and economics.

23. **Omniscient**

Meaning: Knowing everything.

Tip to remember: “Omni” means all, and “scient” means knowing. Omniscient means all-knowing.

Sentence: The novel uses an omniscient narrator who knows every character’s thoughts.

24. **Remarkable**

Meaning: Unusual, impressive, or worthy of attention.

Tip to remember: If something is remarkable, people make remarks about it because it stands out.

Sentence: Her improvement in vocabulary was remarkable.

25. **Sober**

Meaning: Serious, calm, and thoughtful; not drunk.

Tip to remember: GRE often uses sober to mean serious and realistic. A sober judgment is careful, not emotional.

Sentence: The engineer gave a sober assessment of the risks.

26. **Stem from**

Meaning: To originate from or be caused by something.

Tip to remember: Think of a plant stem growing from roots. A problem stems from its root cause.

Sentence: The delay stemmed from poor communication.

27. **Subdued**

Meaning: Quiet, controlled, or less intense.

Tip to remember: Subdued sounds like “softened down.” A subdued person or color is not loud.

Sentence: He was unusually subdued after hearing the news.

28. **Token**

Meaning: A symbol or small sign of something; done only as a gesture.

Tip to remember: A token is a small object that represents something bigger.

Sentence: The company made only a token effort to improve safety.

29. **Unravel**

Meaning: To solve or explain something complicated; or to fall apart.

Tip to remember: Think of untangling a knot. To unravel a mystery is to untangle it.

Sentence: The detective worked hard to unravel the mystery.

30. **Withstand**

Meaning: To resist or survive pressure, attack, or difficulty.

Tip to remember: Withstand means to stand against something.

Sentence: The bridge was designed to withstand strong earthquakes.